PSYC 3303 Exam 1 Topics

Exam 1 will cover chapters 1, 3, 8, 9, and 10 from the APA Handbook. It will also cover material from all of the lecture slides presented thus far.

For the exam, any material covered during the lectures is fair game. However, you should definitely be familiar with:

Chapter 1/Intro to APA Slides

- The five main types of Research articles
- The difference between quantitative and qualitative research articles.
- Case studies
- Literature reviews vs. Research Articles vs. Meta-analyses
- Ethical considerations (plagiarism, conflicts of interest, etc.)
- Predatory journals

Critical Thinking Slides

- Skills used by critical thinkers (slide 3)
- Logical fallacies
- Six steps of problem solving (Slides 10 -11)

Generating Research Topics/Analytical Writing Slides

- What it means to analyze something (e.g., be able to define the process).
- What analytical writing tries to accomplish (slides 3 and 4)
- Basic principles of analytical writing
- The process of narrowing down your ideas
- Thesis statements (what the are and the characteristics of a strong vs weak thesis statement)

Journal Article Reporting Standards (Chapter 3)/Finding and evaluating research articles Slides

- What are scholarly journals? Why do we trust them more than other sources (like Wikipedia)?
- What are the primary components of a research article?
- What is the purpose of a literature review?

- What are the different ways a literature review can be organized?
- What is peer review?
- What is an abstract?

Citing your Sources slides (Chapters 8, 9, and 10)

- What is plagiarism? What is the best way to avoid it? Is it always deliberate or can it be accidental?
- Be familiar with the "bold assertion" problem and how to avoid it.
- Know the components of an APA citation
    - In-text components (name, year)
    - Reference sheet formatting
- Parenthetical vs. narrative citations
- How do primary and secondary sources differ?
- What is paraphrasing AND how do you paraphrase properly? (slides 30-31)
- Direct quotes
    - Short quotes vs. block quotes (when to use which)
- Know why citing matters